An Evening Off

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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by TheSofterGentlerMe

Summary

It's a Saturday night and there's no campers at Camp Bright Moon until the following day. The counselors have a whole evening to themself and it's starting to get a bit wild.

Notes

Shall we?

See the end of the work for more notes

“Yippie I aye ye, Yippie I oh, ghost riders in the sky!” Bow sang out loudly as he strummed the guitar. The other counselors at the camp laughed and applauded as he finished up. He hadn’t been playing the guitar very long and wasn’t the best singer but Glimmer threw her arms around him as she gave him a big kiss on the side of his cheek.

“Good job,” Glimmer said. “You sounded great.”

“Well, I didn’t but I think I’m getting better,” Bow said.

Catra was sprawled out in Adora’s lap in the giant all weather bean bag chair that sat under the pavilion they were all gathered under. The campers from the previous session had all gone home that morning and the next set wouldn’t show up until the following afternoon. For almost twenty-four hours, they had the whole camp to themselves and it was getting a little out of control. Aside from Bow playing the guitar and singing old cowboy songs, Glimmer had busted out the good stuff for everyone to drink, two liters of soda Bow had grabbed the last time he’d had to run to town, and everyone was gulping them back. A few people had even done some dancing and a deck of cards had been produced although a card game hadn’t started yet.

“Bow, my good man, do you perhaps know how to play Sloop John B?” Sea Hawk said where he was sitting beside his girlfriend, Mermista. She rolled her eyes in irritation even as she reached over and took his hand.

“You mean that old rock song?” Glimmer said.

“No! They did a horrible version of it!” Sea Hawk said. He looked appalled as he went on. “It’s not supposed to be like that. It’s supposed to go like this…”

He suddenly started to sing and the gathered group all started good-naturedly shouting at him no and stop.

“I’ll learn it for you, buddy,” Bow said with a grin. “We can do it at one of the campfires.”

Sea Hawk gave a fist pump as Glimmer said, “Alright everyone, we’re not just celebrating, we’re also going to talk about assignments for the next two weeks.” There was a chorus of boos from the group and Glimmer waved her hand in a circle in a hurry it up gesture. “OK, enough of that. Horsehead, you alright with Catra being full time out in the barn with you?”

The guy Glimmer addressed rolled his eyes. His name was Kevin but he’d long since given up trying to get people to call him by anything except his camp nickname.

“Yeah, she’s fine when she’s not sitting around,” Kevin said. Catra threw a bottle cap at him as Kevin laughed.

“Mermista, you alright with Adora continuing to work in the office instead of you?” Glimmer said.

Mermista shrugged as she said, “Sure. She’s got a good handle on it I guess.”

“Adora, that’s a stirring endorsement from her, trust me,” Bow said with a laugh as Mermista made a rude gesture at him.

Glimmer ran down a few more changes before saying, “The rest of us just do our usual thing and that’s all I have. So any ideas for the rest of the evening?”

“Tattoos!” one of the counselors shouted out.

“We’re not doing tattoos,” Glimmer said with a roll of her eyes. Bow had a grin on his face and Glimmer looked at him. “Why do I have a feeling I’m going to regret asking?”

“Have you ever regretted asking me anything?” Bow said blowing a little kiss to her.

“Fair. OK, what’s the idea?” Glimmer said.

“Haircut bonanza,” Bow said as he reached into his bag and pulled out some clippers.

Sea Hawk jumped up on the picnic table he was sitting at and yelled, “Yes! Haircuts!”

A few of the other counselors started chanting the word haircut as Bow plugged in the clippers and pointed at Sea Hawk.

“Do I have a customer?” Bow said.

“Yes, you do, good sir!” Sea Hawk said as he ran over and sat down in a chair in front of Bow.

“Shave off the mustache!” Mermista shouted with a laugh as Bow took the guard off the clippers and ran it around Sea Hawk’s head, staying under the headband that he wore. The hair fell to the floor and Bow took a few more swipes to clean it up and then clapped Sea Hawk on the shoulder.

Sea Hawk jumped up with a shout as another counselor came over and sat down in front of Bow as Glimmer went and sat down next to Catra and Adora.

“Why do I feel like you’ve done this before?” Catra said with a laugh as she watched Bow shave the next person bald.

“We did it last year,” Glimmer said. “Bow still had longer hair and was getting irritated with it. A counselor at the time had some clippers and Bow agreed to let her shave his head. Then a bunch of people went along with it as like a solidarity thing or something.”

Catra sat there staring when she said, “I’m doing it.”

“Doing what?” Adora said.

“I’m getting my hair cut,” Catra said.

“Wait, what!?” Adora said and Catra turned at the alarmed voice.

“Just an undercut, goofball,” Catra said with a grin. “I know you like to run your hands through the hair. I’ll leave some for you.”

Adora blushed a deep red as Glimmer laughed and then Catra stood up and strode forward.

“Wait!” Adora said as she jumped up to her feet and followed. Catra turned around with an irritated look as Adora got up beside her. “I’m doing it too.”

“You sure?” Catra said. Adora had always had long hair and had been quite proud of it as well. “You’re not going to lose your powers like Samson or something?”

“No,” Adora said. “Besides, Delilah did that and in that case it was an act of betrayal…”

“OK, sorry I asked,” Catra said with a laugh as she gently laid a finger on Adora’s lips. Then she turned around and sat down in the chair in front of Bow as she got her hair out of the hair tie it was in. “Undercut, my good barber.”

“Best I can manage,” Bow said. “Hold your hair up for me would you?”

Adora stepped forward and said, “I’ll do that.”

Catra was about to argue when Adora took Catra’s bushy hair in her hands and carefully pulled it up. Bow was doing his best not to smile as he gently said, “Adora, I really appreciate the help but you’re kind of in my way now.”

Adora looked at Catra and then blushed as she let the hair drop and stepped to one side.

“Ummm, sorry about that,” Adora replied, trying not to pay attention to Mermista whistling and clapping. Catra winked at

Adora, which only had her blush harder, as Catra held the hair up out of the way on one side. Bow nodded as he started. Adora leaned against one of the metal poles holding the roof up as she watched Bow make quick work of Catra's hair. When he was done, Catra held her hair up and smiled.

"I think this is the coolest my neck has felt for over a month," Catra said as she put her hair back up as Adora stepped up. "What do you think?"

"Wow," Adora said, almost in a whisper.

"OK, calm down there," Catra said with a laugh. Adora seemed frozen for a moment and then sat down in the chair.

"The same," Adora said to Bow, her voice almost quavering as she took her hair out of its tie.

"You sure about this?" Bow asked as he cleaned up the clippers. Adora just gave a quick nod and pulled up one side of her hair. A few minutes later, she was looking at what looked like an enormous pile of her blonde hair sitting on the ground as she put the rest back up with her hair tie. Then she started laughing in embarrassment as the gathered people started stomping their feet and cheering.

"Where was my applause!?" Catra shouted with a laugh.

“You weren’t half-shaking when you sat down,” Glimmer said as she elbowed Catra.

“How about you go on up there,” Catra said, elbowing her back.

“Just fine with the way it is, thank you very much,” Glimmer said as she flicked at the ends of her hair.

Adora walked over to Catra as the room calmed down and said, “Does… does it look alright?”

“You look amazing, babe,” Catra said as she reached up and ran her hand over the shaved side of Adora’s head. “Oh my God, it’s so soft!”

Glimmer laughed as she said, “Get used to it. That’s half the fun is that baby duck softness.”

They looked around and noticed some of the people kept impulsively running their hands over their heads, half as if they couldn’t believe it and half just enjoying the difference. Bow finished up the last person who wanted to participate and then packed his clippers away. People laughed and talked for a while longer until everyone started to drift off into the night. As Catra and Adora walked towards their trailer, hand in hand under the

twinkling stars, and Adora kept looking over at Catra in the faint moonlight.

"I would have cut my hair sooner if I thought I'd get this kind of attention," Catra said with a grin.

"It's just so different," Adora said as she reached out and touched Catra's head right about her ear. "Does mine look alright?"

Catra stepped up and pulled Adora in close for a kiss before saying, "It looks just fine."

The next morning, Adora woke up to the sunrise throwing shards of colored light through the cut glass crystals hanging in the window. She jumped a little at the feel of the pillowcase on the side of her head before she remembered the night before and then looked at Catra.

"You're finally awake," Catra whispered in the early morning stillness.

"Have you really been sitting here watching me sleep?" Adora whispered back in a teasing voice.

"As if I haven't caught you doing the same a dozen times," Catra said as she reached over and took Adora's hand in her hand and the two sat looking at each other.

“Thank you for being here with me,” Adora said after a moment.

“You don’t have to thank me,” Catra said, looking away in embarrassment.

“But I’m still going to,” Adora said, leaning forward to kiss Catra on the forehead.

Catra grinned as Adora pulled away again as she said, “You still having doubts about us or did the haircut change all of that? Was I a good Delilah to trick you into cutting your hair?”

Adora shook her head as she said, “It was never like that and I told you, you’d have to betray me to be Delilah. Wait? Did you get your hair cut because you thought I’d do the same?”

Catra had a mischievous grin on her face before bursting out into laughter.

“No! I was actually really surprised when you sat down to have your hair cut,” Catra replied. “You’ve always been so into it.”

Adora shook her head with a smile as she rubbed her head against the pillowcase for a moment and said, “That’s because

Mom was always very insistent about keeping my hair presentable and feminine."

"She'd flip if she saw it now," Catra said with a grin as she sat her hand on the side of Adora's head.

"She'd flip about a lot more than that if she was here right now," Adora said with a little laugh.

Catra looked at her wide-eyed for a moment as she said, "I'm sorry, did you just make a joke about her and us?"

Adora's face lost its smile as she said, "Yeah, I guess I did."

"Nope, stop that," Catra said as she gave Adora's shoulder a little shake. "It was funny and that's the first time I've seen you make a little humor out of it."

"I don't know why," Adora said. "It's not like I find the whole thing funny."

"It's alright," Catra said. "I'm just glad to see you smile."

Adora smiled at her as she said, "Well, you should be glad a lot since you make me smile."

“You know just what to say to me, princess,” Catra said as she scooted a little closer and pulled Adora close.

End Notes

The urge to have Bow quote Sweeney Todd to Sea Hawk was strong but I resisted it. I will say Bow singing old cowboy songs is a reference to when I used to go to Boy Scout camp as a kid. One year I got a chance to learn a lot of songs. That was the year some adult leader tried to get a bunch of us to sing *Puff the Magic Dragon* without any songbook. Of course, none of us knew anything but the chorus so we all just kind of hummed along and then jumped in on the chorus. He was actually offended that we weren't singing along. He thought we all knew it and were just being obnoxious even though it was old even then. That being said, I did learn a lot of songs that year and I have to say, singing in a big group like that is a ball. I highly recommend it.

Thank you as always for reading and I hope you all enjoyed this!

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